



## TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

### WEEK 41

Date:  Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

### TOPIC: Cabinet Installation Safety

#### OVERVIEW:

Upper cabinet installation is one of the most physically demanding tasks in finish carpentry — it requires holding heavy boxes overhead while fastening into wall framing, working from ladders or platforms, and making precise adjustments under load. Cabinet failures after installation can cause

#### TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Upper cabinets that are not adequately supported during leveling and shimming create a crush hazard. A cabinet held up by one person while another fastens is not adequately supported — the holder's arms can fail suddenly, and the 50-to-80-pound box can fall onto both workers. Use a cabinet lift or build a temporary ledger board to carry the weight of the cabinet independently so
2. Fastener selection and stud engagement are the two most critical factors in cabinet structural safety. Cabinets must be fastened to wall studs, not to drywall alone. Drywall provides no meaningful load capacity for a cabinet filled with dishes or equipment. Fasteners must engage a minimum of 1.5 inches into solid framing — verify this by measuring total wall assembly thickness
3. After installation, verify the connection quality of every cabinet by applying upward force at the front lower corners of the box. The cabinet should not flex, creak, or shift under hand pressure. If it does, locate additional fasteners to studs before moving on. A cabinet that moves under moderate hand force will eventually fail under the dynamic loading of opening and closing with
4. Upper cabinet installation requires a stable work platform — not a stepladder that is moved every 12 inches. Set up a proper scaffold or adjustable work platform that allows both workers to operate at the correct height with both hands free. Working from a stepladder while holding a cabinet overhead, with one hand on the ladder rail and one on the cabinet, is a recipe for a fall with a

#### DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

Q1: What is our support plan for upper cabinet installation on this project — what equipment do we have to hold cabinets during leveling?

Q2: How do we verify that cabinets are fastened to studs and not to drywall on this wall assembly?

#### KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Locate and fasten to studs — drywall alone cannot support cabinet loads
- Use a cabinet lift or at least two workers for all upper cabinet installations
- Install a temporary ledger board to support cabinets during leveling
- Ensure all mounting screws engage a minimum of 1.5 inches into framing
- Inspect installed cabinets by applying upward force before declaring complete

*Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.*



# CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 41

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

| #  | PRINT NAME | SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat) | #  | PRINT NAME | SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat) |
|----|------------|--------------------------------------|----|------------|--------------------------------------|
| 01 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        | 16 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        |
| 02 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        | 17 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        |
| 03 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        | 18 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        |
| 04 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        | 19 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        |
| 05 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        | 20 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        |
| 06 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        | 21 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        |
| 07 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        | 22 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        |
| 08 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        | 23 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        |
| 09 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        | 24 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        |
| 10 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        | 25 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        |
| 11 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        | 26 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        |
| 12 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        | 27 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        |
| 13 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        | 28 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        |
| 14 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        | 29 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        |
| 15 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        | 30 |            | <a href="#">click to sign</a>        |